

Paint Code Reference

This guide provides a clear reference for vehicle paint codes, helping service personnel, body shops, and owners ensure correct color matching for repairs, touch-ups, and refinishing.

1. Understanding Paint Codes

- Paint codes are unique identifiers assigned to each factory paint color.
 - They ensure precise color matching across all parts of the vehicle, from panels to trims.
 - Codes are typically alphanumeric and can include letters, numbers, or a combination.
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2. Locating Paint Codes

- Most vehicles have a label or plate on the door jamb, under the hood, or inside the glove compartment.
 - The code may also appear in the owner's manual or on the vehicle data sticker.
 - When in doubt, consult the manufacturer's database or dealership for verification.
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3. Standard Paint Code Categories

- **Solid Colors:** Single-layer paint without metallic or pearlescent effects.
 - **Metallic Colors:** Contain small metal flakes that reflect light for depth and sparkle.
 - **Pearlescent Colors:** Incorporate ceramic or mica crystals for a shimmering, layered effect.
 - **Special Finishes:** Includes matte, satin, and custom factory-exclusive colors.
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4. Using Paint Codes for Repairs

- Always provide the exact paint code when ordering paint or replacement panels.
- Mixing or guessing colors can lead to noticeable mismatches and additional rework.

- For partial panel repairs, check that the paint batch is compatible with the original finish type (solid, metallic, pearlescent).
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5. Safety and Handling

- Follow all safety guidelines for handling paints, thinners, and primers.
 - Use appropriate protective gear, including gloves, masks, and eye protection.
 - Store paint products in controlled environments to maintain consistency.
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6. Record Keeping

- Document the paint code used for each vehicle service or repair.
- Include batch numbers and application details when performing multi-step paint processes.
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